GDP also declined from an estimated 10 per cent to 1 per cent. Labour productivity in agriculture rose more than 40 times; 2 per cent of the labour force produced enough cereals and other agricultural products for the population to feed itself and export. The value addition in the non-agriculture economy—industry and services—became 99 per cent of GDP, which made the agriculture economy an almost negligible contributor to employment and value addition from the viewpoint of economic prosperity.

The same story has played out in most other countries of the world. There are as many as sixteen countries today where the share of agriculture in GDP is less than 1 per cent. This includes small nations such as Singapore, Qatar and Luxembourg, and also fairly big economies like the UK, Belgium, Germany and Switzerland. There is a large number of countries where the share of agriculture is between 1 per cent and 5 per cent, including populous countries like Brazil (4.4 per cent), Romania (4.1 per cent), Greece (3.6 per cent), Chile (3.5 per cent), Russia (3.4 per cent), Spain (2.6 per cent), Poland (2.4 per cent), Australia (2.1 per cent), Italy (1.9 per cent), Netherlands (1.6 per cent), South Korea (1.6 per cent), France (1.6 per cent) and Denmark (1.3 per cent). In 2019, the entire European region had about 1.55 per cent of GDP from agriculture. Many of these countries are, in fact, leaders of agriculture in the world and the largest exporters of agricultural produce. And China, now, has less than 7 per cent of GDP coming from agriculture.

There is a very clear correlation in the income level of the economy and the proportion of people employed in agriculture. The richer countries have less than 5 per cent of people employed in agriculture and the poorest countries have more than 50 per cent. In 2019, global GDP from agriculture was only 4 per cent of the total GDP of $87.7 trillion. The GDP growth rate in agriculture has been less than 1 per cent. Data from the International Labour Organization (ILO) indicates that the proportion of people